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I-School Admission Committee
Information School
University of Washington

Professors:

I am pleased to recommend Clark Ngo for admission to the Information School's PhD program at University of Washington. I have worked with Clark for five years in my capacity as Associate Professor and Administrative Faculty at City University of Seattle (CityU).

During this time, Clark has demonstrated an exceptional capacity to combine his academic achievements and research interests. When I joined CityU, Clark was leading a team of graduate student workers supporting Professor Chung's development and implementation of a Full-Stack curriculum. Clark and the CityU team used this project, an AWS apprenticeship grant, to publish three articles supporting the project: Serverless Computing Architecture Security and Quality Analysis for Back-end Development, (2020) Journal of The Colloquium for Information Systems Security Education, VOL 7, #1., Software Documentation and Architectural Analysis of Full Stack Development, 2020, and Decreasing the barrier to entry for an opensource full-stack web development, 2021, Conference on Information Systems Applied Research ISSN, Vol 2167, 1508.

Clark's recent academic contribution, Enterprise AI Course: Cloud-Based Full-Stack DevSecOps with Retrieval-Augmented Generation at the UKC 2024 Conference, demonstrates his ability to maintain academic relevance and integrate new technologies into his academic and consulting work. Clark models an amazing worth ethic in his self-learning, research projects, and content development responsibilities.

Through the five years I have known him, Clark conscientiously combines his academic interests with relevant industry certifications, developing industry contacts, and supporting his teams. His determination, patience, and ability to motivate others are important qualities to support high functioning teams.

An intriguing aspect of Clark's leadership style includes his capacity to build community. During the AWS Full Stack project, Clark mastered the content by teaching his peers. He organized study groups to increase the competency levels of other graduate students while enhancing his own knowledge. I watched Clark mentor another student worker who initially struggled to acquire the content to pass a LINUX certification. His support impacted this student beyond this certification process to successful employment in the Seattle tech scene. Furthermore, prior to the pandemic, Clark actively engaged in Meet-Up groups to build professional networks for himself and the STC community.

Clark's dedication to completing projects, supporting his professors, and attending to details is extraordinary. He is reliable and gives 110% or more to ensure goals are met. In addition to these qualities, Clark possesses an entrepreneurial spirit. He balances opportunities while focusing on his goals.

Clark possesses the technical competencies, research skills, combined with the professionalism, and team skills to be an asset to your PhD program. Please feel free to contact me if you need any further information.

Sincerely,

Morgan Zantua

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